ChefNextDoor
Home-Cooked Food Delivery Platform

Metropolitan University
Department of Software Engineering

Course Title: Web Programming Practice Lab
Course Code: SWE-322: WP
Topic: Project Proposal

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Submission date: 02 April 2026

Project Name: ChefNextDoor

Introduction

ChefNextDoor is a web-based platform designed to connect home-based food creators with nearby customers seeking affordable, homemade meals. The application functions as a simplified local marketplace where chefs can list dishes and users can browse and place orders.

The goal of this project is to develop a complete, functional web application that demonstrates core concepts of web development, including authentication, database design, and CRUD operations.

This project aims to implement a complete web application using PHP (OOP), MySQL, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, fulfilling all core requirements of modern web development.

Problem Statement

In many communities, skilled home cooks lack accessible platforms to sell their food, while customers often struggle to find affordable, homemade alternatives to restaurant meals.

Existing food delivery platforms primarily:

- Focus on registered restaurants rather than individuals.
- Include additional costs such as service and delivery fees.
- Do not support small-scale, home-based food businesses.

As a result, there is a gap between local food producers and potential customers.

Proposed Solution

ChefNextDoor provides a simple and efficient solution by:

- Allowing home chefs to register and showcase their dishes.
- Enabling customers to browse and order homemade food.
- Creating a direct connection between local buyers and sellers.

The system focuses on simplicity, accessibility, and usability, making it suitable for both technical and non-technical users.

Target Users

The application is designed for two main user groups:

1. Home Chefs

- Individuals who prepare food at home and want to sell it locally.
- Require a simple system to list dishes and manage orders.

2. Customers

- Users looking for homemade,healthy, affordable meal options.
- Users who want to try out different types of dishes.

Features

The application will include the following core features:

Authentication & User Management

- User registration and login system.
- Secure password storage.
- Role-based access control (Chef / Customer).

User Profile

- View and update personal information.
- Change password functionality.

Chef Functionality

- Add, edit, and delete dishes (CRUD operations).
- Manage menu listings with price and description.
- View and manage incoming orders.

Customer Functionality

- Browse available dishes.
- View dish details.
- Place orders.
- View order history.

Order Management System

- Create and track orders.
- Order status updates (e.g., pending, accepted, completed).

Additional Features (if time permits)

- Search/filter dishes.
- Rating and review system.

Required and Custom Pages

Required Pages

- **Home Page:** Overview of the platform and its purpose
- **Signup Page:** User registration form
- **Login Page:** User authentication
- **Profile Page:** View and update user information
- **404 Page:** Error handling for invalid routes

Project-Specific Pages

- **Dashboard (Chef/Customer):** Role-based user interface
- **Dish Listing Page:** Display all available dishes
- **Add/Edit Dish Page:** Manage dish information (Chef only)
- **Order Page:** Place new orders (Customer)
- **Order History Page:** View past orders
- **Order Management Page:** Manage incoming orders (Chef)

Project Details (Technical Scope)

Frontend

- HTML, CSS for responsive design
- JavaScript for dynamic interactions
- Form validation for improved user experience

Backend

- PHP (Object-Oriented Programming) for business logic
- Session handling for authentication and authorization
- Error handling and validation

Database

- MySQL database with structured schema
- Core tables: users, dishes, orders, order_items
- Proper relationships using foreign keys

What Makes This Project Useful and Interesting

ChefNextDoor is a practical and scalable concept that reflects a real-world application of web development technologies.

- **Real-world relevance:** Addresses a genuine local marketplace need by supporting small-scale food entrepreneurs.
- **Multi-user system:** Implements role-based functionality, making it more advanced than basic CRUD applications.
- **Full-stack coverage:** Demonstrates frontend design, backend logic, and database integration.
- **Scalability:** The system can be extended in the future with features like delivery tracking or online payments.
- **Portfolio value:** Represents a complete, user-oriented application rather than a simple academic exercise.

ChefNextDoor is a well-scoped, technically appropriate project that fulfills all course requirements while providing meaningful real-world functionality. It effectively demonstrates the ability to design and implement a structured web application with multiple user roles, secure data handling, and interactive features.